

VARRITECH

Provider Decision Matrix

Signed Off by Kareem - March 30, 2026

Prepared for ConvergeFlow

April 2026

Bold ideas wait for no one



All technology provider decisions for ConvergeFlow MVP, reviewed and approved by founder Kareem Maize. Each selection includes alternatives considered and rationale for the final choice.

Field	Value
Selected Provider	Mailforge
Alternatives Considered	Mailgun, AWS SES, SendGrid
Rationale	Purpose-built for cold email. No red tape. Handles DNS, warm-up, IP rotation. Traditional ESPs prohibit cold email.
Status	APPROVED

Field	Value
Selected Provider	Ollama
Alternatives Considered	GPU cluster, OpenAI API, Anthropic API
Rationale	\$20/mo flat vs \$2k/mo GPUs. Not token-based. Sufficient for MVP volume.
Status	APPROVED

Field	Value
Selected Provider	GLM-5 / Minimax 2.7
Alternatives Considered	GPT-4, Claude, Llama
Rationale	Open-source, self-hostable. Zero token costs at scale. Custom fine-tuning possible.
Status	APPROVED

Field	Value
Selected Provider	Multi-API (Apollo, A-Leads, Outscraper, Snov.io, D7)
Alternatives Considered	Single provider, proprietary DB
Rationale	Diversified sources reduce single-provider risk. Data freshness tracking.
Status	APPROVED

Field	Value
Selected Provider	Next.js
Alternatives Considered	React SPA, Vue, Svelte
Rationale	SSR for performance. React ecosystem. Team expertise. Vercel deployment.

Field	Value
Status	APPROVED

Field	Value
Selected Provider	Node.js
Alternatives Considered	Python/Django, Go
Rationale	JavaScript full-stack. Fast development. Shared types with frontend.
Status	APPROVED

Field	Value
Selected Provider	Firebase
Alternatives Considered	PostgreSQL, MongoDB
Rationale	Real-time capabilities. Easy setup. Scales with usage. Good free tier.
Status	APPROVED

Field	Value
Selected Provider	Supabase
Alternatives Considered	Pinecone, Weaviate, Qdrant
Rationale	Free tier. pgvector integration. RAG-ready for knowledge base.
Status	APPROVED

Field	Value
Selected Provider	Vercel + Cloudflare
Alternatives Considered	AWS, GCP, Railway
Rationale	Easy deployment. Bot protection. Edge network. Good DX.
Status	APPROVED

Field	Value
Selected Provider	Clerk

Field	Value
Alternatives Considered	Auth0, Firebase Auth, NextAuth
Rationale	Google/Facebook SSO. Simple integration. Free tier. Good React components.
Status	APPROVED

Field	Value
Selected Provider	Stripe
Alternatives Considered	Square, Braintree
Rationale	Industry standard. Easy setup. Good docs. Subscription management.
Status	APPROVED

Field	Value
Selected Provider	Paddle
Alternatives Considered	Stripe Tax, FastSpring
Rationale	Handles international tax compliance automatically. Merchant of record.
Status	APPROVED

Field	Value
Selected Provider	Mercury
Alternatives Considered	Chase, SVB
Rationale	Startup-friendly. Easy LLC banking setup. Good API.
Status	APPROVED

Field	Value
Selected Provider	Sentry
Alternatives Considered	Bugsnag, Rollbar
Rationale	Free tier. Good Next.js integration. Source maps.
Status	APPROVED

Field	Value
Selected Provider	GCP Monitoring
Alternatives Considered	Datadog, New Relic
Rationale	Cost-effective. Slack alerts integration. Sufficient for MVP.
Status	APPROVED

Field	Value
Selected Provider	Zendesk
Alternatives Considered	Intercom, Freshdesk
Rationale	Ticket system. Optional \$1k AI chatbot add-on. Scales well.
Status	APPROVED

Field	Value
Selected Provider	OpenClaw
Alternatives Considered	Custom build, AgentGPT
Rationale	Open-source. Free. WhatsApp integration possible. Phase 2 deployment.
Status	APPROVED (Phase 2)

Complete Decision Summary

Category	Selected	Status
Email Infrastructure	Mailforge	APPROVED
LLM Inference (MVP)	Ollama	APPROVED
LLM Model	GLM-5 / Minimax 2.7	APPROVED
Lead Generation	Multi-API (Apollo, A-Leads, Outscraper, Snov.io, D7)	APPROVED
Frontend	Next.js	APPROVED
Backend	Node.js	APPROVED
Database	Firebase	APPROVED
Vector DB	Supabase	APPROVED
Hosting	Vercel + Cloudflare	APPROVED
Auth	Clerk	APPROVED
Payments (US)	Stripe	APPROVED
Payments (Global)	Paddle	APPROVED
Banking	Mercury	APPROVED
Error Monitoring	Sentry	APPROVED
Logging	GCP Monitoring	APPROVED
Support	Zendesk	APPROVED
AI Agent (DWY)	OpenClaw	APPROVED (Phase 2)

Approved: Kareem Maize - March 30, 2026

Technical Program Manager: Cristiano Varriale (christian@varritech.com)